RAJASTHANI COLLECTION

NO. 02



RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Gatte Ki Sabzi

Steamed Gram Flour Dumplings
in Spiced Yogurt Curry

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Gatte Ki Sabzi

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Gatte Ki Sabzi

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Curry That Doesn't Need Fresh Vegetables

Gatte ki sabzi stands as one of Rajasthani cuisine's clearest examples of resourceful desert cooking — a genuinely satisfying curry built without a single fresh vegetable, relying instead on gatte, firm dumplings made from besan (gram flour) that's shelf-stable and available year-round, regardless of what the harsh Thar desert climate allows to grow at any given time.

The technique itself is precise: a firm gram flour dough is shaped into long ropes, boiled until cooked through, then sliced into pieces and simmered in a tangy, spiced yogurt-based gravy. This method — boiling before simmering in gravy — gives gatte a distinctive, slightly chewy texture that holds up well in the sauce without disintegrating, technically similar to Bihar's besan ki sabzi featured elsewhere in this cookbook series, though each region's version carries its own spice character.

Gatte ki sabzi has become one of Rajasthan's most recognized dishes precisely because it demonstrates the state's broader culinary philosophy: genuine creativity and flavor born from constraint, using pantry staples to build something that tastes anything but limited.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Curry That Doesn't Need Fresh Vegetables, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

A defining example of Rajasthani desert cooking, built entirely from shelf-stable gram flour rather than fresh vegetables. Shares a similar core technique with Bihar's besan ki sabzi, reflecting a broader Indian tradition of gram flour dumplings as a practical vegetable substitute in resource-conscious cooking. Now one of Rajasthan's most recognized dishes, served in homes and restaurants regardless of vegetable availability. Demonstrates the ingenuity at the heart of Rajasthani cuisine, which developed largely in response to the challenges of a demanding desert climate.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

20m	30m	4	Med
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowl
- Large pot, for boiling the gatte
- Kadai or wide pan, for the gravy
- Whisk
- Sharp knife, for cutting the boiled gatte

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Gatte ki sabzi keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days, though the gravy thickens as it sits — thin with a splash of water when reheating. The uncooked gatte dough or boiled, unsliced gatte can be refrigerated separately for a day if needed.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the gatte

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Besan (gram flour)	1½ cups	180 g	1½ katori
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Turmeric powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Red chili powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Yogurt	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Water, as needed	3–4 tbsp	45–60 ml	3–4 chammach

For the yogurt gravy

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Plain yogurt, whisked	1½ cups	360 g	1½ katori
Besan (gram flour)	2 tbsp	15 g	2 tbsp
Water	2 cups	480 ml	2 katori
Oil or ghee	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the yogurt gravy (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Curry leaves — optional	1 sprig	8–10 leaves	1 sprig
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish requires only besan, yogurt, and pantry spices, making it one of the most accessible recipes in this collection for cooks anywhere in the world without access to Indian specialty vegetables. Besan is widely available at Indian grocers and in the gluten-free aisle of many general supermarkets.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Gatte

01 MAKE THE DOUGH

Combine the besan, ajwain, turmeric, chili powder, yogurt, oil, and salt. Gradually add water, kneading to a firm, smooth dough — similar in consistency to a stiff bread dough.

02 SHAPE INTO ROPES

Divide the dough into 3–4 portions and roll each into a thin rope, about ¾ inch / 2 cm thick.



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Making the Gatte, continued

03 BOIL UNTIL FIRM

Bring a large pot of water to a gentle boil and add the dough ropes, cooking for 12–15 minutes, until firm and cooked through — they'll float when nearly done.

Chef tip. keep the water at a gentle simmer rather than a rolling boil, which can cause the ropes to break apart.

04 COOL AND SLICE

Remove the cooked ropes and let cool for a few minutes, then slice into rounds, about ½ inch / 1 cm thick. Reserve the cooking water — it's useful for the gravy.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The gatte ropes should feel firm and slightly springy when pressed, with no doughy center, before you remove them from the boiling water.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Yogurt Gravy

05 WHISK THE YOGURT BASE

Whisk the yogurt and besan together until smooth, then gradually whisk in the water to create a smooth, pourable base.

06 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop, then cumin seeds, asafoetida, and curry leaves if using. Add the ginger-garlic paste, cooking until fragrant.

07 ADD SPICES AND THE YOGURT BASE

Add turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder, stirring briefly, then reduce heat to low and add the yogurt-besan mixture, stirring constantly for the first minute to prevent splitting.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Yogurt Gravy, continued



08 SIMMER AND ADD THE GATTE

Simmer the gravy for 12–15 minutes, until thickened and the raw besan taste is gone. Add the sliced gatte and salt, simmering for a final 5 minutes to let them absorb the gravy's flavor.

Texture indicator. the gravy should coat the back of a spoon, with the gatte tender but still holding their shape distinctly.

09 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Yogurt Gravy, continued

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Boiling the yogurt gravy too vigorously, especially right after adding the yogurt-besan mixture, is the most common cause of a split, grainy sauce. Keep the heat low and stir constantly for the first minute.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with roti or steamed rice, a Rajasthani home-cooking staple regardless of season.
- A reliable dish for days when fresh vegetables aren't available or in season.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A hearty vegetarian main dish alongside rice and a simple side, requiring minimal fresh produce.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a protein-rich curry alongside any grain, appealing to those seeking meat-free options.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- A firm, well-kneaded dough, similar to bread dough, produces gatte that hold their shape well in the simmering gravy.
- Simmering the yogurt gravy gently, rather than at a hard boil, is essential for a smooth, non-split sauce.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Gatte can be boiled and sliced a day ahead, refrigerated, and added to fresh gravy when ready to serve.
- This dish is genuinely practical to keep on hand as a pantry-based backup meal, requiring no fresh vegetables at all.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some Rajasthani restaurants lightly pan-fry the sliced gatte in a little ghee before adding them to the gravy, giving a slightly crisp edge that adds textural contrast.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

240 kcal	10 g	22 g	13 g	5 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Classic Gatte Ki Sabzi	the tangy yogurt-based version featured here.
Govind Gatta Curry	a richer, stuffed variation — see our dedicated recipe card in this collection.
Fried Gatte Ki Sabzi	gatte lightly fried before simmering, for extra texture.

Why did my gatte fall apart while boiling?

Likely the water was boiling too vigorously, or the dough wasn't kneaded firmly enough. Keep the water at a gentle simmer and knead the dough until smooth and firm.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make this ahead for a busy week?

Yes — boiled, sliced gatte keep refrigerated for a day or two, ready to add to fresh gravy when needed.

Is gatte ki sabzi very spicy?

It has moderate warmth from the chili powder, adjustable to taste — not typically among the spicier dishes in Rajasthani cuisine.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Gatte	firm gram flour dumplings, the centerpiece of this dish.
Besan	gram flour, the base ingredient for both the gatte and the gravy thickener.
Ajwain	carom seeds, used in the gatte dough for aroma.
Tadka	a tempering of spices bloomed in hot oil, essential to this dish's flavor base.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Gatte Ki Sabzi

20m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Med
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

GATTE

Besan	180 g
Ajwain	1.5 g
Turmeric powder	1 g
Red chili powder	1 g
Yogurt	30 g
Oil	30 ml
Salt	3 g
Water	45–60 ml

YOGURT GRAVY

Plain yogurt	360 g
Besan	15 g
Water	480 ml
Oil or ghee	45 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Curry leaves — optional	8–10 leaves
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Make the dough.** Combine the besan, ajwain, turmeric, chili powder, yogurt, oil, and salt.

02 **Shape into ropes.** Divide the dough into 3–4 portions and roll each into a thin rope, about ¾ inch / 2 cm thick.

03 **Boil until firm.** Bring a large pot of water to a gentle boil and add the dough ropes, cooking for 12–15 minutes, until firm and cooked through — they'll float when nearly done.

04 **Cool and slice.** Remove the cooked ropes and let cool for a few minutes, then slice into rounds, about ½ inch / 1 cm thick.

05 **Whisk the yogurt base.** Whisk the yogurt and besan together until smooth, then gradually whisk in the water to create a smooth, pourable base.

06 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop, then cumin seeds, asafoetida, and curry leaves if using.

07 **Add spices and the yogurt base.** Add turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder, stirring briefly, then reduce heat to low and add the yogurt-besan mixture, stirring constantly for the first minute to prevent splitting.

08 **Simmer and add the gatte.** Simmer the gravy for 12–15 minutes, until thickened and the raw besan taste is gone.

09 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Besan	see recipe	☐ Ajwain	1.5 g
☐ Turmeric powder	see recipe	☐ Red chili powder	see recipe
☐ Yogurt	30 g	☐ Oil	30 ml
☐ Salt	see recipe	☐ Plain yogurt	360 g
☐ Oil or ghee	45 ml	☐ Mustard seeds	4 g
☐ Cumin seeds	4 g	☐ Asafoetida	pinch
☐ Curry leaves — optional	8–10 leaves	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Coriander powder	3 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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